

BEFORE

From 1511, the Portuguese, Dutch, Spanish, English, and French bargained and fought for control of Southeast Asia and Australasia.

EUROPEAN PROFITS

The Portuguese captured the Malaysian peninsula in 1511, moved on to the Spice Islands (the Moluccas) in 1513, and then China, Japan, and Indonesia. The Spanish arrived next, setting up **plantations** in the Philippines in 1565. Two

private trading companies followed—the English East India Company (1600), based in India, and the Dutch East India Company (1602), which set up colonies in Asia.



COOK IN BOTANY BAY

CLAIMS ON AUSTRALIA

In 1770, James Cook

◀ 320–321 explored Australia's fertile east coast, and claimed New South Wales for Britain. In 1829, Britain claimed the whole of Australia, and in 1840, annexed New Zealand too. In both cases, this action preempted French colonization.

The European colonization of Australia began in 1788 with the establishment of a British penal colony in Botany Bay (modern Sydney), New South Wales. Until then, Britain had transported convicts to North America, but the American Revolution (see pp.298–99) made this impossible. The use of Britain's new Australian colony for this purpose had been proposed in 1779, by English botanist Sir Joseph Banks. The natives seemed more peaceful than the Maoris of New Zealand—and this was to prove

and armed resistance proved ineffectual. Foreign diseases, to which the Aboriginal population had little resistance, also caused widespread mortality. A smallpox epidemic broke out in 1789, followed by influenza, typhus, chicken pox, whooping cough, tuberculosis, and syphilis.

A stolen generation

The prevalent view of Aboriginals is of a desert people, but this is only because they were driven into arid areas that were of no interest to British settlers: in

Waitangi with the Maoris in 1840. The chiefs ceded sovereignty in return for protection and guarantees against further encroachment on their lands.

However, the treaty was not upheld, and the settlers' continuing demands for land led to the New Zealand (or Maori) Wars, fought between 1843–47 and 1860–72. The Maoris were equipped with firearms acquired through decades of trading, and fought back staunchly. The first outbreak of war was contained relatively quickly, but the second became a protracted

Colonial Resistance

Resistance to the European colonization of Australia, New Zealand, and Southeast Asia brought very different outcomes for the indigenous populations. In Australia and New Zealand, it led to the subjugation of the Aboriginals and Maoris; in Southeast Asia, to eventual independence.



Dene-Harding revolver

The explosive power of European firearms such as this Dene-Harding revolver ensured that the colonizing powers swiftly overcame indigenous populations.

their downfall. When James Cook landed in 1770 (see BEFORE), there were 300,000–350,000 Aboriginals in

Australia. Over the next 150 years, this figure declined by 80 percent. Initially, relations between native inhabitants and settlers were amicable, but as the colony expanded, the Aboriginals resisted. Their arrows and spears were no match for British guns, however,

1788 the Aboriginal population was concentrated in the same fertile areas as the most populous parts of modern Australia. British governors were instructed to protect the Aboriginals, but they often imposed British values and, in the late 19th century, even removed native children (the “Stolen Generation”) from their families, and moved them into state institutions.

Maori wars

Maori resistance to European settlers in New Zealand was more fierce. Both Dutch explorer Abel Tasman and Cook received violent receptions, but Cook noted that tribal differences made united resistance unlikely. By the early 19th century, European and US seal and whale hunters were trading with the Maoris. As disputes among tribes and between Maoris and settlers were common (and to preempt French

and American interests), Britain negotiated the Treaty of

guerrilla campaign that cost the lives of around 1,000 Europeans and some 2,000 Maoris.

3 MILLION acres of Maori land was confiscated in the 19th century, and most Maoris were confined to New Zealand's less fertile North Island

75 PERCENT of the Maori population still lived there at the end of the 20th century

The Dutch East Indies

During the 17th and 18th centuries, the Dutch monopolized trade with the Spice Islands (so named because prized spices, such as nutmeg, originated there), and took control of most of what is now Indonesia. In the 1790s, the Dutch East India Company (see BEFORE) collapsed and the Dutch government took over. From 1830 it forced Indonesian peasants to grow export crops, such as indigo and coffee, at set prices and, from 1870, allowed Dutch investors to lease land and establish plantations. This led to an outbreak of nationalist resistance, and the Dutch fought a series of wars between 1821 and 1901. Ultimately,

Ticket of leave

After being transported to Australia in chains, some convicts who had served a proportion of their sentence with good behavior were granted a Ticket of Leave (TOL) passport and allowed restricted travel.

